MODULE 7

Make a Difference

"Every individual matters.
Every individual has a role to play.
Every individual makes a difference."

— JANE GOODALL

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How can one person make a meaningful difference in their local or global community?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Farmer Will Allen and the Growing Table**	· Jacqueline Briggs Martin	BIOGRAPHY
2	**One Plastic Bag**	· Miranda Paul	BIOGRAPHY
3	**Energy Island**	· Allan Drummond	NARRATIVE NONFICTION
4	**The Storyteller's Candle**	· Lucía González	HISTORICAL FICTION

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A · Vocabulary (26) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 13

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 16

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 7 · Make a Difference · Grade 3 · 26 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

outreach

When a program or people do **outreach**, they —

- ◯ **A.** stay quietly at home alone.
- ◯ **B.** build a tall fence around a yard.
- ◯ **C.** reach out to offer help to others in need.
- ◯ **D.** count the money they have saved.

Q2 L.3.6

fellowship

Fellowship is —

- ◯ **A.** a friendly feeling between people who share experiences.
- ◯ **B.** a large boat that carries people across the sea.
- ◯ **C.** a quiet argument between two strangers.
- ◯ **D.** a list of rules posted on a wall.

Q3 L.3.6

communal

Something is **communal** when it is —

- ◯ **A.** kept secret from everyone else.
- ◯ **B.** owned by only one rich person.
- ◯ **C.** brand new and never used.
- ◯ **D.** shared by a group of people in the same community.

Q4 L.3.6

residents

The **residents** of a city are —

- **A.** the cars that drive through it.
- **B.** the people who live there.
- **C.** the visitors who leave the same day.
- **D.** the streets and buildings in it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FARMER WILL ALLEN AND THE GROWING TABLE

Q5 L.3.4 TRAP

scarce

Fresh vegetables were **scarce** in the city. If something is **scarce**, —

- **A.** there is very little of it.
- **B.** it looks frightening or scary.
- **C.** there is far too much of it.
- **D.** it is found only in the ocean.

Q6 L.3.4

greenhouses

Will packed his land with **greenhouses**. **Greenhouses** are —

- **A.** houses that are painted green.
- **B.** deep holes dug into the ground.
- **C.** glass buildings used to grow plants and protect them from the weather.
- **D.** trucks that carry vegetables to market.

Q7 L.3.4

pollution

Pollution is —

- **A.** clean rain that helps plants grow.
- **B.** harmful or poisonous material in the air, water, and ground.
- **C.** a kind of healthy soil for a garden.
- **D.** a tool used to dig up weeds.

Q8 L.3.5 TRAP

crowded

Will **crowded** the greenhouse with rows of plants. If you **crowded** a space, you —

- ◯ **A.** shouted loudly to a big crowd of people.
- ◯ **B.** left it empty and bare.
- ◯ **C.** cleaned it until it was spotless.
- ◯ **D.** filled it up with no room left for anything else.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FARMER WILL ALLEN AND THE GROWING TABLE (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.4

vats

Will added **vats** of water and fish to his farm. **Vats** are —

- ◯ **A.** large tanks or tubs that can hold water or other liquids.
- ◯ **B.** small seeds planted in a row.
- ◯ **C.** thin sheets of glass.
- ◯ **D.** wooden tools for digging.

Q10 L.3.4

vertical

Will grew food in **vertical** rows to save space. Something that is **vertical** —

- ◯ **A.** lies flat along the ground.
- ◯ **B.** rolls in a circle.
- ◯ **C.** stands tall or points up.
- ◯ **D.** floats on top of water.

Q11 L.3.4

factories

Factories are —

- ◯ **A.** small gardens behind a house.
- ◯ **B.** open fields where animals graze.
- ◯ **C.** stores where people buy fresh fruit.
- ◯ **D.** large buildings where things are built or made by people and machines.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ONE PLASTIC BAG

Q12 L.3.4

confesses

"I broke your basket," Isatou **confesses**. If someone **confesses** something, they —

- ◯ **A.** keep it a secret forever.
- ◯ **B.** admit to doing or saying something wrong.
- ◯ **C.** laugh about it with friends.
- ◯ **D.** blame it on someone else.

Q13 L.3.5 TRAP

forage

The goats **forage** for food among the trash. When animals **forage**, they —

- ◯ **A.** search through an area to find food.
- ◯ **B.** build a strong fort out of sticks.
- ◯ **C.** sleep through the whole winter.
- ◯ **D.** race four at a time across a field.

Q14 L.3.4

recycled

The women made purses from **recycled** plastic. Something that is **recycled** has been —

- ◯ **A.** thrown away and buried.
- ◯ **B.** bought brand new at a store.
- ◯ **C.** used again or used in a different way.
- ◯ **D.** grown in a garden.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ENERGY ISLAND

Q15 L.3.4

cable

Electricity came to the island by **cable** under the sea. A **cable** is —

- ◯ **A.** a small fishing boat.
- ◯ **B.** a flat map of the ocean.
- ◯ **C.** a tall tower on a hill.
- ◯ **D.** a bundle of wires with a thick covering that carries electricity.

Q16 L.3.4

environmental

Søren was an **environmental** teacher. Something that is **environmental** is connected to —

- **A.** building tall city skyscrapers.
- **B.** protecting Earth's land, water, animals, and air.
- **C.** playing music in a band.
- **D.** counting money at a bank.

Q17 L.3.4

renewable

Wind is a kind of **renewable** energy. Something that is **renewable** —

- **A.** will always be available.
- **B.** will soon run out for good.
- **C.** can only be found underground.
- **D.** is too dangerous to use.

Q18 L.3.5 TRAP

converted

The islanders **converted** wind into electricity. When something is **converted**, it is —

- **A.** carried away in a truck.
- **B.** covered with a warm blanket.
- **C.** changed to a different form or changed in an important way.
- **D.** kept exactly the same as before.

Q19 L.3.4

resources

Wind and sunlight are **resources** the island can use. **Resources** are —

- **A.** mistakes that need to be fixed.
- **B.** stories told around a fire.
- **C.** rules that everyone must follow.
- **D.** things people can use to get a job done.

Q20 L.3.4

willing

The neighbors were **willing** to work together. If you are **willing** to do something, you are —

- **A.** afraid to even try.
- **B.** ready to do it.
- **C.** too tired to move.
- **D.** angry about the plan.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE STORYTELLER'S CANDLE

Q21 L.3.5 TRAP

slender

The candle was tall and **slender**. If something is **slender**, it is —

- **A.** thin.
- **B.** loud and noisy.
- **C.** wide and heavy.
- **D.** warm to the touch.

Q22 L.3.5 TRAP

gallant

The little mouse was **gallant** in the play. If you are **gallant**, you are —

- **A.** a big art room where people paint.
- **B.** running as fast as you can.
- **C.** thoughtful and very brave.
- **D.** sleepy and slow.

Q23 L.3.5 TRAP

chimed

"I want to help, too!" the others **chimed** in. If you **chimed** in, you —

- **A.** rang a large brass bell.
- **B.** said something to agree with what someone else said.
- **C.** climbed up a tall ladder.
- **D.** walked away without a word.

Q24 L.3.4

preparations

The community made **preparations** for the fiesta. **Preparations** are —

- **A.** the people who come to watch a show.
- **B.** the costumes worn in a play.
- **C.** the songs sung at a party.
- **D.** the things that have to be done to get ready for an event.

Q25 L.3.4

flickered

The candle flame **flickered** in the dark. If a flame **flickered**, it —

- **A.** gave off a light that moved in an unsteady way.
- **B.** burned steady and still.
- **C.** went out and stayed dark.
- **D.** turned a bright blue color.

Q26 L.3.5 TRAP

concluded

When the fiesta **concluded**, everyone went home. When you have **concluded** something, you have —

- **A.** only just started it.
- **B.** made it much bigger.
- **C.** ended it.
- **D.** forgotten all about it.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 7 · Make a Difference · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.3.1 · RI.3.2 · RI.3.3 · RI.3.5 · RI.3.6 · RI.3.8 · RL.3.1 · RL.3.2 · RL.3.3 · RL.3.5 · RL.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Farmer Will Allen and the Growing Table

BIOGRAPHY · JACQUELINE BRIGGS MARTIN / ERIC-SHABAZZ LARKIN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.3.2

What is this biography mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How Will Allen played basketball when he was a young man.
- ◯ **B.** How Will Allen became an urban farmer and taught a city to grow its own food.
- ◯ **C.** How red wiggler worms turn food garbage into rich compost.
- ◯ **D.** How greenhouses keep growing plants safe from the cold weather.

Q2 RI.3.3

Why did Will Allen want to start a farm in the city?

- ◯ **A.** He wanted to win a farming prize.
- ◯ **B.** He needed a place to keep his basketballs.
- ◯ **C.** He saw that fresh food was scarce and believed everyone has a right to good food.
- ◯ **D.** He wanted to live far away from people.

Q3 RI.3.3

How did Will fix the "dirty," lifeless soil on his city lot?

- ◯ **A.** He used food garbage and red wiggler worms to turn it into rich compost.
- ◯ **B.** He poured clean water over it every day.
- ◯ **C.** He bought brand-new soil from a store.
- ◯ **D.** He left the lot empty and waited.

Q4 RI.3.5

The author tells about Will's life from when he was a boy to when he traveled the world. What text structure is this?

- **A.** A list of recipes to follow.
- **B.** A question-and-answer format.
- **C.** A made-up fairy tale.
- **D.** Chronological order, telling the events of his life in the order they happened.

Q5 RI.3.3

How did Will grow enough food on a small city lot?

- **A.** He packed greenhouses with vertical rows of plants and added vats of water and fish.
- **B.** He planted only one kind of vegetable.
- **C.** He grew all the food on the roof of his car.
- **D.** He shipped his food in from another country.

Q6 RI.3.3

How did Will make his "table" feed many more people?

- **A.** He sold his farm and moved away.
- **B.** He taught teenagers, families, and others to become farmers themselves.
- **C.** He kept all the food for his own family.
- **D.** He stopped growing food in the winter.

Q7 RI.3.6

The author quotes Will saying he "loved digging in the dirt." Why does the author use Will's own words?

- **A.** To prove that Will did not like farming.
- **B.** To explain how to plant potatoes.
- **C.** To show exactly how Will felt, even though the author is telling the story.
- **D.** To list the rules of basketball.

Q8 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "Farmer Will Allen and the Growing Table"?

- **A.** Before he was a farmer, Will Allen was once a professional basketball player.
- **B.** Red wiggler worms can turn food garbage into rich compost for the soil.
- **C.** Thousands of people now visit Will Allen's farm in Milwaukee every year.
- **D.** One person can make a difference by growing good food and teaching a whole community to farm.

Selection 2 · One Plastic Bag

BIOGRAPHY · MIRANDA PAUL / ELIZABETH ZUNON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.3.2

What is "One Plastic Bag" mostly about?

- **A.** How the women taught themselves to crochet thread into purses.
- **B.** How the goats in Isatou's village got sick from eating plastic.
- **C.** How Isatou Ceesay turned wasted plastic bags into purses and cleaned up her village.
- **D.** How Isatou's old palm-leaf basket broke and fell apart.

Q10 RI.3.3

What problem did the plastic bags cause in Isatou's village?

- **A.** They piled up as ugly trash, and goats that ate them got sick and died.
- **B.** They made the village too colorful.
- **C.** They floated away on the river.
- **D.** They were too useful to throw away.

Q11 RI.3.3

What did Isatou and her friends do to solve the problem?

- **A.** They burned all the bags in a big fire.
- **B.** They washed the bags, cut them into thread, and crocheted them into purses.
- **C.** They asked the goats to stop eating the bags.
- **D.** They moved to a different village.

Q12 RI.3.3

How did the other women in the village react to the recycled purses at first, and then later?

- **A.** They liked them right away and never changed.
- **B.** They threw the purses into the trash.
- **C.** They told Isatou to stop making them.
- **D.** First one woman bought a purse, then more and more, until everyone wanted one.

Q13 RI.3.1

According to the selection, how did making purses help the women besides cleaning the village?

- **A.** It taught them how to drive.
- **B.** It gave them money they could earn by selling the purses.
- **C.** It helped them learn to swim.
- **D.** It made the rain stop falling.

Q14 RI.3.6

The author uses Isatou's own language, such as the word *mbuba*, in the story. Why does the author do this?

- ◯ **A.** To make the story harder to read.
- ◯ **B.** To show that Isatou speaks English at home.
- ◯ **C.** To show the real language Isatou's people speak in the Gambia.
- ◯ **D.** To explain how plastic is made.

Q15 RI.3.8

The selection shows that one person's idea changed the whole village. Which detail BEST supports this idea?

- ◯ **A.** Isatou's recycling idea spread until soon everyone wanted a purse and the village grew cleaner.
- ◯ **B.** Grandmother served spicy rice and fish.
- ◯ **C.** Rain drummed on the aluminum roof.
- ◯ **D.** Isatou carried a palm-leaf basket.

Q16 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "One Plastic Bag"?

- ◯ **A.** Goats in the village ate the thrown-away plastic bags and got sick.
- ◯ **B.** The women cut the bags into strips and rolled them into thread.
- ◯ **C.** People in the village paid for the purses with dalasi coins.
- ◯ **D.** One person's persistence and a recycling idea can change a whole community.

Selection 3 · Energy Island

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · ALLAN DRUMMOND · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.3.2

What is "Energy Island" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How the people of one island worked together to make their own clean energy.
- ◯ **B.** How a ferry boat carries people back and forth to the island of Samsø.
- ◯ **C.** How the farmers of Samsø raise cows and grow potatoes and strawberries.
- ◯ **D.** How one cold, windy winter blackout left the whole island in the dark.

Q18 RI.3.3

Why was the island of Samsø chosen for the energy project?

- ◯ **A.** It was the largest island in the world.
- ◯ **B.** Denmark picked it as the ideal place to become independent of nonrenewable energy.
- ◯ **C.** It had no people living on it.
- ◯ **D.** It was the warmest place in Denmark.

Q19 RI.3.3

What did the teacher Søren Hermansen do to make the project work?

- **A.** He built every wind turbine by himself.
- **B.** He moved away from the island.
- **C.** He told the islanders to give up.
- **D.** He worked for years to convince his neighbors to work together and think big.

Q20 RI.3.3

What finally made the whole island want to make their own energy?

- **A.** A scientist gave everyone money.
- **B.** The ferry boat stopped running.
- **C.** During a blackout, Brian Kjær's wind turbine kept his lights on.
- **D.** The farmers ran out of crops to grow.

Q21 RI.3.5

The author uses a map and illustrations of windy weather. How do these graphic features help the reader?

- **A.** They tell the reader the price of the book.
- **B.** They show how to build a boat.
- **C.** They name the people who live on the island.
- **D.** They show where Samsø is and how windy the island is.

Q22 RI.3.1

According to the selection, why is the island such a good place to make wind energy?

- **A.** It is always very windy there, in the middle of the sea.
- **B.** It never rains or snows there.
- **C.** It has the tallest mountains in Denmark.
- **D.** It is warm and sunny all year long.

Q23 RI.3.8

The author shows that the community made a big difference. Which detail BEST supports this idea?

- **A.** The island has a harbor where fishing boats come in.
- **B.** By working together, Samsø reduced its carbon emissions by 140 percent in just ten years.
- **C.** Kids on the island play soccer.
- **D.** The island grows potatoes and strawberries.

Q24 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "Energy Island"?

- **A.** At first, Samsø looked like an ordinary island in the middle of Denmark.
- **B.** The big wind turbines on the island have long blades that spin in the wind.
- **C.** A community working together, sparked by one person, can change how it uses energy.
- **D.** Søren Hermansen was the teacher who first got the islanders to listen.

Selection 4 · The Storyteller's Candle

HISTORICAL FICTION · LUCÍA GONZÁLEZ / LULU DELACRE · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.3.2

What is "The Storyteller's Candle" mostly about?

- **A.** How the children practiced and put on a play for Three Kings' Day.
- **B.** How cold the winter felt to a family who missed warm Puerto Rico.
- **C.** How a librarian welcomed Puerto Rican immigrants and brought their community together.
- **D.** How the ship Ponce sailed all the way from Puerto Rico to New York.

Q26 RL.3.3

At the beginning of the story, how do Hildamar and Santiago feel about living in New York?

- **A.** They miss the warmth of their island, Puerto Rico, and feel cold.
- **B.** They want to move even farther north.
- **C.** They never think about Puerto Rico at all.
- **D.** They love the snow more than anything.

Q27 RL.3.3

Who is Pura Belpré, and what does she do?

- **A.** She is a teacher who moves away from the city.
- **B.** She is a child in Hildamar's class.
- **C.** She is a ship captain who sails to Puerto Rico.
- **D.** She is the first Puerto Rican librarian at the library, who shares Spanish stories with the children.

Q28 RL.3.3

Why does Titi Maria change her mind about the library?

- **A.** The library gives away free food.
- **B.** Pura Belpré welcomes them in Spanish, so the family helps make costumes for the fiesta.
- **C.** The library is the warmest place in the city.
- **D.** She wants to borrow a candle.

Q29 RL.3.3

How does the community work together for the Three Kings' Day fiesta?

- **A.** Some build the stage and make costumes and curtains, while the children practice the play.
- **B.** Only Pura Belpré does all the work alone.
- **C.** They cancel the fiesta because it is too cold.
- **D.** They buy everything ready-made from a store.

Q30 RL.3.6

Pura Belpré says, "The library is for everyone." What does she mean?

- **A.** Only people who speak English may come in.
- **B.** The library will soon close down.
- **C.** The library welcomes everyone, including Spanish-speaking families.
- **D.** Books are only for grown-ups.

Q31 RL.3.5

The story begins on a cold day in New York and ends with the warm Three Kings' Day fiesta. How does the story move from beginning to end?

- **A.** It tells the same day over and over.
- **B.** It moves forward in time as the community prepares for the fiesta, event by event.
- **C.** It is written as a list of facts about libraries.
- **D.** It starts at the end and goes backward.

Q32 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "The Storyteller's Candle"?

- **A.** The winters in New York are much colder than they are in Puerto Rico.
- **B.** Hildamar is chosen to play one of the parts in the Three Kings' Day play.
- **C.** A ship called the Ponce sails for five days from Puerto Rico to New York.
- **D.** One welcoming community leader can give immigrants a sense of belonging and keep their culture alive.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 7 · Make a Difference · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how one person can make a meaningful difference in a community. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Farmer Will Allen and the Growing Table,"** Will saw a problem in his community and took action. Show the PROBLEM he saw, the ACTIONS he took, and the RESULT for his community.

PROBLEM → ACTION → RESULT · WILL ALLEN

THE PROBLEM	WILL'S ACTIONS	THE RESULT

How did taking responsibility help Will make a difference for the people in his city? Explain.

Q2 Change DOK 3

In **"One Plastic Bag,"** Isatou's village CHANGES from a place full of trash to a cleaner, healthier community. Trace THREE steps in that change, then explain how one person started it.

HOW THE VILLAGE CHANGED · ONE PLASTIC BAG

STEP 1 · THE PROBLEM

what was wrong in the village?

STEP 2 · THE IDEA

what did Isatou and her friends do?

STEP 3 · THE CHANGE

how did the village become different?

How did one person, Isatou, start a change that helped her whole community? Explain.

Q3 Connection DOK 3

In **"Energy Island,"** the people of Samsø had to CONNECT and work together. Show how ONE person and the WHOLE community each helped, and what they achieved together.

WORKING TOGETHER · ENERGY ISLAND

ONE PERSON (SØREN OR A NEIGHBOR)	THE WHOLE COMMUNITY

What did the islanders achieve by connecting and working together? Why could they not do it alone?

Q4 Responsibility / Community DOK 3

Two selections show people making a difference in different ways. Compare HOW **Will Allen** in Farmer Will Allen and the Growing Table and the islanders in **Energy Island** each helped their community.

TWO WAYS TO MAKE A DIFFERENCE

WILL ALLEN · A CITY FARM	SAMSØ · ENERGY ISLAND

What does each one show about making a difference? (Hint: one person leading / a whole community working together.)

Q5 Community / Responsibility DOK 4

Essential Question: How can one person make a meaningful difference in their local or global community? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

How did this person (or community) make a difference (seeing a problem, taking action, helping others, recycling, working together)?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

How did this person (or community) make a difference (seeing a problem, taking action, helping others, recycling, working together)?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 7 · Make a Difference · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Empty Lot

On the corner of Maya's street was an empty lot. It was full of weeds and old trash. No one liked to walk past it. One day Maya had an idea. "We could turn this lot into a garden," she said. At first the other kids laughed. But Maya did not give up. She asked her neighbors for help. Slowly, people began to listen. On Saturday, a small group came with rakes and bags. They pulled the weeds and picked up the trash. Then they planted seeds for beans, tomatoes, and bright flowers. All summer the neighbors took turns watering the plants. By fall, the ugly lot had become a green garden full of food. Families came to share the vegetables. Children played among the flowers. Maya smiled. One person's idea had changed the whole corner. The garden showed that when neighbors work together, they can make their street a better place to live.

154 WORDS · LEXILE 410–460L · RIT 195–201

Q1 RIT 195 · Lexile 410L · Key Detail

What was on the corner of Maya's street at the start?

- ◯ **A.** An empty lot full of weeds and trash.
- ◯ **B.** A tall new school.
- ◯ **C.** A green garden.
- ◯ **D.** A wide river.

Q2 RIT 197 · Lexile 420L · Key Detail

What did Maya want to do with the lot?

- ◯ **A.** Build a parking lot.
- ◯ **B.** Turn it into a garden.
- ◯ **C.** Sell it for money.
- ◯ **D.** Leave it the way it was.

Q3 RIT 199 · Lexile 440L · Cause & Effect

What happened after the neighbors pulled the weeds and planted seeds?

- ◯ **A.** The lot stayed full of trash.
- ◯ **B.** Everyone moved away.
- ◯ **C.** By fall, the lot became a green garden full of food.
- ◯ **D.** The plants never grew.

Q4 RIT 200 · Lexile 450L · Vocabulary

The passage says Maya "did not give up." This means she —

- ◯ **A.** ran away from the problem.
- ◯ **B.** handed the lot to someone else.
- ◯ **C.** forgot her idea.
- ◯ **D.** kept trying even when it was hard.

Q5 RIT 201 · Lexile 460L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Empty Lot"?

- ◯ **A.** When neighbors work together, they can make their street a better place.
- ◯ **B.** The most important thing is that beans and tomatoes grow well in summer.
- ◯ **C.** The lot was full of weeds and trash that no one wanted to walk past.
- ◯ **D.** The best part of the story is that the kids planted seeds on a Saturday.

Passage 2 · The Reading Buddy

Diego was in fifth grade, and he loved to read. One day his teacher told the class about a problem. Many younger children at the school were having a hard time learning to read. They needed extra help, but the teachers were very busy. Diego wanted to do something. He asked if he could become a reading buddy. Every Tuesday after lunch, Diego sat with a first grader named Sam. At first, Sam did not like books at all. The words felt too hard. But Diego was patient. He picked funny stories about dogs and dinosaurs. He let Sam point to each word. He cheered when Sam got one right. Week by week, Sam grew braver. Soon he could read a whole page by himself. By spring, Sam was reading out loud to the class with a big smile. Diego learned that even a kid can make a real difference. By giving a little of his time, he helped another child love to read.

164 WORDS · LEXILE 470–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 · Lexile 470L · Key Detail

What problem did Diego's teacher tell the class about?

- ◯ **A.** The school had run out of books.
- ◯ **B.** Many younger children were having a hard time learning to read.
- ◯ **C.** The lunchroom was too noisy.
- ◯ **D.** The playground was closed.

Q7 RIT 204 | Lexile 490L | Key Detail

What did Diego do to help?

- **A.** He wrote a new book.
- **B.** He taught the teachers.
- **C.** He bought books for the school.
- **D.** He became a reading buddy for a first grader named Sam.

Q8 RIT 205 | Lexile 500L | Cause & Effect

What happened to Sam after weeks of reading with Diego?

- **A.** By spring, he could read out loud to the class with a big smile.
- **B.** He stopped coming to school.
- **C.** He still hated books.
- **D.** He became the teacher.

Q9 RIT 206 | Lexile 510L | Inference

The passage says Diego "was patient" and picked funny stories. This suggests that Diego —

- **A.** wanted Sam to feel bad.
- **B.** cared about helping Sam enjoy reading.
- **C.** was bored by the whole job.
- **D.** did not really like to read.

Q10 RIT 207 | Lexile 530L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Reading Buddy"?

- **A.** The most important thing is that Diego picked funny stories about dogs and dinosaurs.
- **B.** The story is mainly about how busy the teachers at the school were.
- **C.** Even a kid can make a real difference by giving a little of his time to help someone.
- **D.** Sam met with Diego to read together every Tuesday after lunch.

Passage 3 · The Beach Cleanup

Every summer, Lina's family visited the seaside town where her grandmother lived. Lina loved the soft sand and the cool waves. But one year she noticed something sad. The beach was covered with litter. Plastic bottles, bags, and bits of foam lay all along the shore. Lina learned that this trash can hurt sea animals. Turtles sometimes swallow plastic bags, thinking they are jellyfish. Lina decided to act. She made a sign that read "Beach Cleanup Saturday!" and put it up at the town store. On Saturday morning, she was afraid no one would come. But slowly people arrived, carrying gloves and bags. Children, parents, and even her grandmother joined in. Together they filled twenty big bags with trash. By noon, the sand was clean again, and the waves sparkled. The town decided to hold a cleanup every month. Lina was proud. She had seen a problem and helped her community fix it. One sign had brought many helping hands together.

161 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 · Lexile 540L · Key Detail

What sad thing did Lina notice at the beach?

- ◯ **A.** The waves were too cold.
- ◯ **B.** There were no shells left.
- ◯ **C.** The beach was covered with litter.
- ◯ **D.** The store had closed.

Q12 RIT 209 · Lexile 560L · Cause & Effect

Why does plastic trash on the beach hurt sea animals?

- ◯ **A.** Turtles sometimes swallow plastic bags, thinking they are jellyfish.
- ◯ **B.** It makes the water too warm.
- ◯ **C.** It scares away the seagulls.
- ◯ **D.** It blocks the sunlight.

Q13 RIT 210 · Lexile 570L · Key Detail

What did Lina do to get people to help?

- ◯ **A.** She cleaned the whole beach by herself.
- ◯ **B.** She called the police.
- ◯ **C.** She waited for the trash to wash away.
- ◯ **D.** She made a sign and put it up at the town store.

Q14 RIT 211 · Lexile 580L · Inference

The passage says Lina was "afraid no one would come," but then people arrived. This suggests that —

- ◯ **A.** the cleanup was canceled.
- ◯ **B.** her community was willing to help once someone got it started.
- ◯ **C.** the townspeople did not care about the beach.
- ◯ **D.** Lina decided to stay home.

Q15 RIT 212 · Lexile 600L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Beach Cleanup"?

- ◯ **A.** The story is mainly about how much Lina loved the soft sand and cool waves.
- ◯ **B.** The most important fact is that turtles can mistake plastic bags for jellyfish.
- ◯ **C.** The best part is that Lina visited her grandmother by the sea each summer.
- ◯ **D.** One person who sees a problem can bring a whole community together to fix it.

Passage 4 · Wangari's Trees

Wangari Maathai grew up in Kenya, in Africa. When she was a girl, her village was green with trees and clear streams. People grew their own food, and birds sang in the branches. But years later, when Wangari returned home, much had changed. Many trees had been cut down. Without roots to hold the soil, the land had become dry and bare. Streams had dried up, and families could not grow enough food. Wangari believed she could help. She had a simple but powerful idea: plant trees. She showed the women of her country how to grow young trees from seeds and care for them. At first only a few women joined. But the idea grew, just like the trees. Over many years, people planted more than thirty million trees across Kenya. The new trees brought back shade, healthy soil, and clean water. Wangari's work showed the world that one determined person, with one simple idea, can help heal a whole country.

162 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 Lexile 610L Key Detail

What had changed in Wangari's village when she returned home?

- ◯ **A.** Many trees had been cut down, and the land had become dry and bare.
- ◯ **B.** The village had become a big city.
- ◯ **C.** The streams had flooded the streets.
- ◯ **D.** The birds had learned to talk.

Q17 RIT 214 Lexile 630L Key Detail

What was Wangari's idea to help?

- ◯ **A.** To build a new road.
- ◯ **B.** To plant trees and teach women to grow them.
- ◯ **C.** To move everyone to the city.
- ◯ **D.** To bring water in by truck.

Q18 RIT 214 Lexile 650L Vocabulary

The passage calls Wangari a "determined person." Someone who is **determined** —

- ◯ **A.** gives up easily.
- ◯ **B.** is unsure what to do.
- ◯ **C.** will not stop until the job is done.
- ◯ **D.** stays at home all day.

Q19 RIT 215 Lexile 670L Cause & Effect

What happened after people planted millions of new trees?

- ◯ **A.** The land became even more bare.
- ◯ **B.** The trees were all cut down again.
- ◯ **C.** The women stopped working together.
- ◯ **D.** The trees brought back shade, healthy soil, and clean water.

Q20 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Wangari's Trees"?

- **A.** The story is mainly about how Wangari grew up in a green village in Kenya.
- **B.** One determined person, with one simple idea, can help heal a whole country.
- **C.** The most important fact is that young trees can be grown from seeds.
- **D.** The best part is that birds came back to sing in the branches again.